



Pramod Kumar, secretary of Boxing Federation of India with AIFF president Kalyan Chaubey. R.V. MOORTHY

follow automatically," he said. The panel was moderated by Raveendran Sankaran, director general cum CEO, Bihar State Sports Authority.

Governance in Sports — Navigating challenges to become stronger federations

Pramod Kumar, secretary of Boxing India, urged National Sports Federations to work for the welfare of athletes at the district level.

"No federation works on the grassroots. It is a sensitive matter which can decide an athlete's future. Sometimes, the decisions are not welcome by the athletes, at times they are wrong. At times, the state associations do not know what the right thing to do. And this process continues. This is social work. You can at most spend two terms in office. But people want to stick around for as long as possible. They barely care about the sport or the athletes," he said at the *Sportstar Focus Bihar Conclave*.

A former track athlete, Pramod

recalled an incident from his career where a decision from sports federation cost him a place at the Asian Championships.

"I won the all-university in 1984. In 1985 I was first in 10,000 metre but the guy who was second went for the Asian Championships. What was worse was that the China athlete was slower than me yet won the gold. Nobody cares about athletes, it is tough to admit that," he said.

All India Football Federation president Kalyan Chaubey was the second member of the panel and said that National Sports Federations have to judge their progress over longer spells of time.

"So many players have jobs and incentives today. This was not the case 10-15 years back. Today athletes have better infrastructure, they can travel by plane and stay in the best hotels, they have proper broadcast. We never imagined these facilities.

"But people always pick out the faults. When you govern, you have to assume that you can not deliver all the things correctly. A federation's task is to run the sport with the government. Today, we try to give all the facilities that we wished we had as players. In a country of 150 crore

population, we cannot expect overnight change. We have to see how we are progressing. I try to use my perspective I had as a player to work better as an administrator," he said. The session was moderated by Sportstar's Assistant Editor, Jonathan Selvaraj.

The Host Nation Effect: Why Olympics hosts outperform and can India do it too?

Joydeep Karmakar, Commonwealth Games gold medallist, acknowledged the rapid strides India is making in Olympic sports, but stressed the importance of focusing on the rate of improvement. "There is a chance of a 25 to 50 per cent increase in medals when you become a host. But it doesn't imply the quality; it is about the quantity. Even if we go by 25 to 50 per cent of an increase in medals, India will still win 17 to 18 medals, and that is not top 10. We will not be happy to win 17 to 20 medals in 2036. There is no doubt that India is progressing, but everybody else is also doing that. We have to check the rate of improvement in Indian sports and not only talk about us doing well," Joydeep said.

Rajesh Rajagopalan, CEO of Dani